

Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.

A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 7NT

Declarer: North

Lead: ♣Q

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4NT

Declarer: East

Lead: ♥9

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4NT

Declarer: South

Lead: ♥4

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: West

Lead: ♠5

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 7NT

Declarer: North

Lead: ♠Q

Board: 6

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 7NT

Declarer: East

Lead: ♠10

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 8 5
 ♥ 8 7 6 5 2
 ♦ 6 5
 ♣ 5 2

♠ K 6 2

♥ A 10 9

♦ A K 3

♣ A K 8 4



♠ 10 9 4 3

♥ Q J 4

♦ 10

♣ Q J 10 9 3

♠ A 7

♥ K 3

♦ Q J 9 8 7 4 2

♣ 7 6

SOUTH isn't sure just how much he can make, but surely 6♦ isn't too much to hope for.

He starts with a Gerber 4♣ and NORTH shows three Aces.

Hmmm, 5♣ asks for Kings and NORTH shows three.

Hmm, SOUTH can now count all thirteen tricks, so he forgets about the ♦ slam and bids 7NT.

West	North	East	South
	2NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
Pass	5NT	Pass	7NT
All Pass			
7NT by North			
Lead: ♣Q			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 8

♥ J 7 2

♦ 8 5

♣ A K Q 10 9 6

♠ 9 7 4 2

♥ A 10 8 5 3

♦ J 10

♣ 3 2



♠ A K Q

♥ K Q 6

♦ K Q 3

♣ J 8 7 5

♠ 10 6 5 3

♥ 9 4

♦ A 9 7 6 4 2

♣ 4

West

North

East

South

4♣

Pass

4♥

Pass

4NT

All Pass

4NT by East

Lead: ♥9

WEST has 13 points and can contribute six tricks so she figures that twelve tricks will be a slam (dunk).

However, just to make sure the opponents don't take the first two tricks she checks with Gerber.

Uh Oh, missing two Aces she signs off at 4NT. She could also happily play 5♣, but it would be tricky to get there. Very tricky.

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 4 3
 ♥ A 8 5 4
 ♦ J 7 4 2
 ♣ 9 4

♠ A Q 6

♥ K 7 3

♦ K 6

♣ K 10 6 5 3



♠ J 10 8 2

♥ J 10 2

♦ Q 10 5

♣ J 8 2

♠ K 7 5

♥ Q 9 6

♦ A 9 8 3

♣ A Q 7

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

4NT

1NT

All Pass

4NT by South

Lead: ♥4

Yes, this has nothing to do with Gerber or Blackwood, but everything to do with smart bidding.

NORTH has a 16 points and SOUTH has 15, 16 or 17. NORTH wants to be in 6NT if SOUTH has 17, but merely a Notrump game if she has 15 or 16.

The way to find out is to bid 4NT - not Blackwood but merely an invitation to bid 6NT. In this case, SOUTH has but 15 points and declines the invitation. If her ♥Q were changed to the ♥A she would bid 6NT and collect her twelve easy tricks.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 8 7 6

♥ Q J 7

♦ A J 3

♣ A 8 2

♠ 10 5 3

♥ A 4 3 2

♦ Q 10 9 2

♣ 9 3



♠ K Q J 4

♥ K 6

♦ K 4

♣ K Q J 10 5

♠ 9 2

♥ 10 9 8 5

♦ 8 7 6 5

♣ 7 6 4

When WEST opens 1NT EAST hopes his hand includes all four Aces so she can bid 7NT. So she uses Gerber to find out.

But, when she discovers they are missing an Ace she settles for 6NT.

West

1NT

4NT

All Pass

6NT by West

Lead: ♠ 5

North

Pass

Pass

East

4♣

6NT

South

Pass

Board 5

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 8 5 4 3
♥ 7 4
♦ 10 8 6 4
♣ Q 10 3

♠ A K
♥ A Q 10 9 6
♦ A Q J 3
♣ A K



♠ Q J 10 6
♥ 8 2
♦ 9 5 2
♣ J 9 8 5

♠ 9 7 2
♥ K J 5 3
♦ K 7
♣ 7 6 4 2

NORTH has a pretty good hand, and when SOUTH shows ♥ support she naturally thinks about slam.

She has all four Aces but she wants to know about Kings. Unfortunately she can't start at 5NT because that has a different meaning, so she goes through the 4NT sequence even though she already knows the Ace answer.

Finding SOUTH with two Kings was what she wanted.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
Pass	5NT	Pass	6♥
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			
7NT by North			
Lead: ♠Q			

Board 6

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 7
♥ K 9
♦ A Q J 10 4
♣ A Q J 7

♠ J 8 4 3
♥ J 7 6 2
♦ 6 3
♣ 10 9 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 6 2
♥ A 10 4
♦ K 7 5
♣ K 8 6 2

♠ Q 10 9 5
♥ Q 8 5 3
♦ 9 8 2
♣ 5 4

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	Pass	2NT	Pass
4 ♣	Pass	4 ♠	Pass
5 ♣	Pass	5 ♠	Pass
7NT			
All Pass			
7NT by East			
Lead: ♠ 10			

WEST is just shy of a 2♣ opening bid, and when EAST shows 13-15 points WEST wants to be in a slam.

WEST cannot use Blackwood because 4NT would be a natural invitation, but with EAST's latest bid being 2NT he can use Gerber.

Two Major Aces and two Minor Kings fill the holes in WEST's hand so he bids 7NT.